
Problem 5 (20 points). Mongolian answer 20+bonus1+explanation bonus 5=26

(1) Match each Mongolian name with its Latin transliteration and its meaning. Fill in the blank by writing down the number of the Mongolian place names listed above. (1x17)

	Mongolian	Latin transliteration	Chinese translation
example	0	<i>mongol</i>	蒙古
a	6	<i>ordos</i>	鄂爾多斯
b	16	<i>bugutu</i>	包頭
c	5	<i>xöndelen</i>	昆都倫
d	2	<i>jarud</i>	扎魯特
e	13	<i>tümed</i>	土默特
f	11	<i>arun</i>	阿榮
g	17	<i>xaraqin</i>	喀喇沁
h	8	<i>üjümüqin</i>	烏珠穆沁
i	7	<i>naiman</i>	奈曼
j	1	<i>xoringer</i>	和林格爾
k	4	<i>buiir</i>	貝爾
l	15	<i>dalat</i>	達拉特
m	3	<i>sönid</i>	蘇尼特
n	14	<i>xölün</i>	呼倫
o	9	<i>dörbed</i>	杜爾伯特、四子王
p	10	<i>darxan</i>	達爾罕
q	12	<i>xoolin</i>	霍林

(2) Write down the correct Latin transliterations for the following place names. (1x4)

Mongolian	Latin transliteration	Chinese translation	Syllable-by-syllable transliteration
	<i>xorqin</i>	科爾沁	 <i>xo</i>  <i>r</i> (syllable-ending)  <i>qi</i>  <i>n</i> (syllable-ending)
	<i>jalaiid/jalaiit*</i>	扎賚特	 <i>ja</i>  <i>la</i>  <i>ii</i>  <i>d/t</i> (syllable-ending)
	<i>oros</i>	俄羅斯	 <i>o</i>  <i>ro</i>  <i>s</i> (syllable-ending)
	<i>haiilar</i>	海拉爾	 <i>ha</i>  <i>ii</i>  <i>la</i>  <i>r</i> (syllable-ending)

*:  may be transliterated as *jalaiiun*. But **laiiun* is not a possible syllable in Mongolian. As is stated in hints, the four words have different ending letters. As the first word must be *xorqin*, which ends with *n*, this word must end with the syllable-ending *d/t*. Since *d/t* are not identifiable in Mongolian scripts, either transliteration is correct.

Solution:

Mongolian letters:

	Latin transliteration	Position
	<i>a</i>	initial
	<i>o</i>	initial
	<i>ü</i>	initial
	<i>xa</i>	initial
	<i>xo</i>	initial
	<i>xö</i>	initial

ᠪᠤ	bu	initial
ᠨᠠ	na	initial
ᠵᠠ	ja	initial
ᠰᠤ	sö	initial
ᠳᠠᠲᠠ	da/ta	initial
ᠳᠥᠳᠦᠲᠥᠲᠦ	dö/dü/tö/tü	initial
ᠢ	i	middle
ᠢᠢ	ii	middle
ᠣᠤᠶᠤᠨ	o/u/ö/ü	middle
ᠬᠠ	ha	middle
ᠭᠡ	ge	middle
ᠭᠣᠭᠤ	go/gu	middle
ᠪᠡ	be	middle
ᠨᠢ	ni	middle
ᠮᠠᠮᠡ	ma/me	middle
ᠮᠤᠮᠦ	mu/mü	middle
ᠵᠤᠵᠦ	ju/jü	middle
ᠻᠢ	qi	middle
ᠯᠠᠯᠡ	la/le	middle
ᠯᠢ	li	middle
ᠯᠤᠯᠦ	lu/lü	middle
ᠳᠡᠲᠡ	de/te	middle
ᠳᠣᠲᠣ	do/to	middle
ᠷᠣᠷᠤ	ro/ru	middle
ᠷ	-r (syllable-ending)	middle
ᠨ	-n (syllable-ending)	middle
ᠳᠤᠲᠤ	du/tu	final
ᠳᠤᠲᠤ	-d/t (syllable-ending)	final
ᠨ	-n (syllable-ending)	final
ᠷ	-r (syllable-ending)	final
ᠰ	-s (syllable-ending)	final

(The *-un* looks exactly the same as “-d/t” in the final.) That’s why the ending letters of “*arun*” and “*dalat*” look exactly the same.

Mongolian word	Syllable-by-syllable transliteration
ᠠᠷᠨ	ᠠ — a ᠷ — ru ᠨ — n (syllable-ending)

	— da — la — t (syllable-ending)
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It is easier to start from the head of each word.

1. By looking the topmost part of each Mongolian word, we can see that two groups of words have the same

letter: and , which start with “bu”; and , which start with “xö”. But it seems that

and end with the same letter, so the former ones must be “buiir” and “bogutu”. As “buiir” has two “i”, it is easy to know that 4 is “buiir” and 16 is “bugutu”. Then from word length we can know that 14 is “xölün” and that 5 is “xöndelen”.

2. “Buiir” shares the same ending letter with “xoringer”, so we can know that 1 is “xoringer”.

3. Then we look at the start of “xoringer”, we can find that 12 is “xoolin”, which has the exactly the same starting letter “ho” as “xoringer”.

4. Now we can deduct the form of letter “r” in the middle of the word. is the letter “r” in the middle.

By combining the start of “xoringer” and the form of letter “r” in the middle, it is easy for us to spot “xaraqin”, which is 17. If we look at the ending of “xaraqin” in detail, we can know that 8 is “üjümüqin”, which shares exactly the same ending with “xaraqin”.

5. Now we can find out all words that starts with a vowel. As the ending of “ordos” is unique, we can know that 6 is “ordos”. Then 11 is “arun”.

6. By looking at “ordos” and “bugutu”, we can know that “d” and “t” (ᠳᠤ) are written in the exactly same form. If we look at the words unsolved, we can find that except for “sonid”, “jarud” and “naiiman”, four of the words start with “d” or “t”. We’ve already known the form of “r”, so 2 must be “jarud”. “Buiir” has two “i” and so is “naiiman”, so 7 must be “naiiman”. Then “3” must be “sonid”, as it has a unique starting letter.

7. Now, all of the words left have the same starting letter. By looking at “sonid” and “jarud”, we can know the form of the syllable-ending “d/t”, which should be , so we can know that 9 is “dörbed” and that 10 is “darhan”.

8. The two words left unsolved are “dalat” and “tümed”. One way to distinguish them is to learn the form of letter “l” and letter “m”. From “xoolin”, “xölün” and “xöndelen”, we can know the form of “l” in the middle, which should be and “m” is . So 13 is “tümed” and 15 is “dalat”.